THE ELON GAZETTE

Weekday briefing on what Elon Musk is saying and doing

WEDNESDAY, OCTOBER 14, 2026

THE MORNING PICTURE

A start time for the Roadster, a federal review of Starbase, and SpaceXAI heads to City Hall

Tesla says its Roadster demonstration will stream live on Thursday at 8:55 p.m. EDT, and Elon Musk added, "Timing is everything." The Federal Aviation Administration (FAA) began a full environmental review of SpaceX's plan for up to 456 Starship launches a year from Starbase, Texas, and SpaceX shares fell 4.21% on Tuesday. SpaceXAI agreed to testify before the New York City Council on Friday after a subpoena fight.

Musk's roughly $366 million in midterm giving is due to appear in a federal filing on Thursday, The Guardian reported. On X, he promoted Grok Bot through much of Tuesday, told chief executives that posting directly on X beats a press release, and said that, despite leading a podcast's beer count, he hardly ever drinks.

I · POLITICS

The donations, on paper Thursday

The figures first reported Monday are expected in a federal filing this week.

$366M	$276M	$158M
Known giving in the 2026 midterm cycle	Since July alone	To the Senate Leadership Fund

Musk has become the biggest political donor of the 2026 midterm cycle, with about $366 million given to political groups and campaigns, The Guardian reported on Tuesday; the numbers, first reported by The New York Times, "will be released in a federal filing on Thursday." Beyond the $158 million to the Senate Leadership Fund and $76 million to America PAC, he gave $10 million in January to Nate Morris, a Kentucky Republican Senate candidate who withdrew in May to become US ambassador to Colombia, the Guardian said. Over the weekend Musk reposted an America PAC video of Texas Democratic Senate candidate James Talarico's statements on gender, calling it "madness," the paper added. The election is November 3.

II · TESLA

"Timing is everything"

The Roadster gets a start time after nearly nine years of waiting.

Roadster: Thursday, 8:55 p.m. EDT

"Roadster event streaming live this Thursday," Tesla posted at 8:25 p.m. EDT Tuesday, giving a start of 7:55 p.m. Central, which is 8:55 p.m. EDT. Musk quoted it: "Timing is everything." The invite-only outdoor demonstration near Waco, Texas, was pushed back from October 1 because of high winds. Tesla first showed the Roadster in November 2017 and promised production in 2020; it has not delivered one, Electrek noted, and Musk has promoted SpaceX cold-gas thrusters for the car.



Building 1 at Tesla's Gigafactory Texas near Austin, shown on June 17, 2022.

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"Feels like magic"

"Tesla self-driving feels like magic," Musk posted on Tuesday. New release notes for Tesla software 2026.38.5.1 describe FSD (Supervised) improvements for older Hardware 3 cars, trained "using HW4 V14 as a guide," according to Tessie. Separately, Tesla paused Canadian orders of the China-built Model 3 Premium until March 2027, Electrek reported.

III · SPACEX, GROK & X

A Starbase review, and a subpoena settled

The FAA will study a plan for hundreds of Starship launches a year; SpaceXAI will answer New York lawmakers' questions on AI safety.

456 launches a year

The FAA published a notice today that it will prepare a programmatic environmental impact statement on SpaceX's plan to expand Starship operations at Starbase. SpaceX proposes up to 100 launches and 200 landings a year at first, rising later to 456 launches and 912 landings, against 25 launches allowed now, Invezz reported; comments are due November 30. Ship 40, the first Starship to return to its launch site, now stands in a Megabay at Starbase for study of its flown heatshield and engines.



The launch tower's arms catch a Super Heavy booster at Starbase, Texas, during Starship's fifth flight test on Oct. 13, 2024.

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SpaceXAI at the City Council

After skipping an October 5 hearing despite a subpoena, SpaceXAI agreed to testify before the New York City Council's Committee on Technology on Friday at 10 a.m. EDT, amNY reported. OpenAI, Anthropic, Google and Meta have already testified under oath. "Conspicuously absent was SpaceXAI, which is unacceptable," Speaker Julie Menin said in a statement.

Grok Bot, and advice for CEOs

Musk spent much of Tuesday promoting Grok Bot, the agent that carries out tasks for users, including LEGO sets he said it had bought. Quoting Google chief executive Sundar Pichai's launch post for Gemini 4 Argon, he wrote: "CEOs & execs posting to the public directly on X is the best way to get your message out and drive product sales. Vastly more powerful and effective than a press release." On a post about a Morgan Stanley note casting SpaceX as a distributed inference cloud, he wrote: "True, this is a very big deal."

On the record

No new interviews since Tuesday morning. A podcast's tally of pints drew a reply.

The Cheeky Pint count October 13, 2026

A post ranking guests on Stripe co-founder John Collison's Cheeky Pint podcast by beer consumed put Musk first, with three full pints of Guinness. "Funny thing is that I hardly ever drink alcohol!" Musk replied.

Coming up

Thursday, 8:55 p.m. EDT: the Roadster livestream on Tesla's X account. Friday, 10 a.m. EDT: SpaceXAI before the New York City Council Committee on Technology (council).

Takeaways

1. The Roadster livestream starts Thursday at 8:55 p.m. EDT; Musk: "Timing is everything."
2. The FAA opened a full environmental review of up to 456 Starship launches a year at Starbase.
3. SpaceXAI will testify to the New York City Council on Friday after a subpoena standoff.
4. Musk's roughly $366 million in midterm giving is due in a federal filing Thursday.
5. Musk told CEOs posting on X is "vastly more powerful" than a press release.

Sources

Posts by @elonmusk, @Tesla and @SpaceX.

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